Saint Edward High School vs. Mentor	3/7/2026	Prepared by: Coach Donelon

Mentor enters the District Championship game with an overall record of 16–8. They are a smaller and physically immature team but play with relentless energy and thrive on momentum. They want to play fast and will pressure aggressively, often trapping recklessly in the press. We should not change our approach—our size, strength, and maturity give us an advantage. If we remain poised and attack their press with strong fundamentals, including throwing over or diagonally against pressure, we can dictate the pace on our terms. Mentor will trap after defensive rebounds and may blitz inbound situations. In the half court, they tend to stay connected to their assignments and do not defend the gap aggressively, which can create driving opportunities. Mixing in occasional defensive looks could disrupt their rhythm. We must also be disciplined on closeouts, particularly with #5, who has a tendency to flop on contested threes. Ultimately, the keys will be playing with poise, handling pressure without turning the ball over, controlling the glass, and imposing our physicality. If we dictate the pace, avoid careless turnovers, and play with confidence and swag, we can control the game.

Favorite Sets	Last 2 Minute Sets/ Special Situations
MOTION	BLOB - BOX TO X ACTION
DRIVE AND KICK	BLOB - BOX - S+S
PIN DOWN	BLOB - 4 HIGH - S+S
PULL SHIRT - BALL SCREEN TO WEAK SIDE DOUBLE	BLOB - FLAT TWO - "BAMA" / BLOB - FLAT ONE
BALL SCREEN TO BACK SCREEN	BLOB - 4 LOW - POST ENTRY - "1 FINGER"
PISTOL	PULL SHIRT

Offensive Tendencies	Defensive Tendencies
28.8 3PT ATTEMPTS PER GAME	Man to man in the half court
31% 3PT AS TEAM	Have shown very little zone - Mainly show man
17.3 FTA PER GAME	Full Court man - Will show some Double Team - Step Up
13.5 OFFENSIVE REBOUNDS PER GAME	1-3-1
19.1 ASSISTS PER GAME	DHO - Have pushed at times
13.7 TURNOVERS PER GAME	Post Defense - Slip Front or Behind
	Ball screens - Over top / Big Zone off - Will switch

Strengths	Weaknesses
HIGH VOLUME 3PT SHOOTING TEAM	PLAYING FROM BEHIND
OFFENSIVE REBOUNDING	ZONE OFFENSE
ABILITY TO GET 2-3 RUNS OF 8-0 PER GAME	FREE THROW SHOOTING
TEMPO OF GAME	

LAST FIVE GAMES

Date	Opponent	Score	Leading Scorer	Leading Rebounds	Leading Assists
3/3	Whitmer	90 - 63 W	#4 - 19 points	#4 - 6 rebs	#2 - 10 assists
2/27	Lorain	83 - 59 W	#11 - 14 points	#4/30 - 5 rebs	#2 - 5 assists
2/23	Lakewood	61 - 58 L	#22 - 11 points	#2 - 6 rebs	#2 - 9 assists
2/20	Medina	68 - 63 L	#41 - 17 points	#14 - 6 rebs	#2 - 8 assists
2/14	Glenville	76 - 71 W	#2 - 21 points	#22 - 10 rebs	#2 - 9 assists

Keys To Victory	

Thoughts for the game

PLAY ST. EDWARD HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL

GUYS TO FOUL IN LATE GAME SITUATION	GUYS TO AVOID FOULINIG
#5 - #22 - #4 - #41	#2

STARTERS

LEFTY		SOPH	17.3 PPG	**PRIMARY PG - GLASS**	
#2 Jack Kennedy	**5'9**	**140 LBS**	86% FT	KEEP HIM IN FRONT - KEEP OFF GLASS - NO PAINT TOUCHES	

This very quick guard is their primary point guard and plays with great pace. 25% of his field goal attempts have come from three, and he is shooting 28% from beyond the arc. He is a solid ball handler who can score off the catch or off the dribble and will pull up for a mid-range jumper. He has the ability to finish going left or right, but when in doubt, he prefers to get back to his left hand using a crossover or spin move. He will finish through contact and also uses a floater in the lane.

Defensively, he is very active in passing lanes with 80 steals on the season and is extremely active on the glass, averaging 8.4 rebounds per game. We must eliminate paint touches, keep him in front, keep him off the glass, and be prepared to close out under control on all perimeter shots.

RIGHTY		SOPH	7.8 PPG	**HIGH VOLUME 3PT - PASSING LANES**	
#5 Tommy Pavicic	**6'0**	**145 LBS**	68% FT	CONTEST OUTSIDE SHOTS - NO FACE CUTS	

This player is a perimeter-oriented guard with 69% of his field goal attempts coming from the three-point line, and he is currently shooting 32% from three. He is primarily a catch-and-shoot threat from the outside, showing confidence in stepping into rhythm shots. He moves well without the basketball, working to free himself through spacing and relocation, and must be accounted for at all times off the ball. When he does put the ball on the floor, he has decent handles and is looking to attack to his right hand to finish at the rim. However, he does not finish well through contact, which presents an opportunity to be physical and wall up at the point of attack. Defensively, he is very disruptive — extremely active in the passing lanes with 60 steals on the season, so we must be strong and sharp with our passes. Defensively against him, we must contest all outside shots, eliminate clean catch-and-shoot opportunities, and take away his rhythm. No face cuts, stay connected off the ball, and eliminate paint touches by forcing him into contested attempts.

RIGHTY		JUNIOR	7.0 PPG	**HIGH VOLUME 3PT**	
#22 Bernard Gnjatic	**6'1**	**165 LBS**	50% FT	LOCATE EARLY - CONTEST SHOTS	

This guard is an extreme perimeter-oriented player, with 80% of his field goal attempts coming from the three-point line, and he is shooting 40% from three-point range. He is primarily a catch-and-shoot threat from the outside and is comfortable shooting well beyond the arc. He does a very good job playing off two feet, which allows him to stay balanced and under control whether preparing to shoot or attacking a closeout. He will utilize a shot fake into a one-dribble pull-up to create time and space, proving he is more than just a stationary shooter. In transition, he will leak out looking for early offense opportunities, so we must locate him immediately when possession changes. In the half court, he moves well without the basketball and will cut to the rim when defenders lose vision. If he puts the ball on the floor, he is primarily looking to finish going right at the rim.

Defensively, we must locate him early in transition, run him off the three-point line, and contest all outside shots. Discipline on closeouts is critical — take away his catch-and-shoot rhythm while staying down on shot fakes and forcing him to put the ball on the deck.

RIGHTY		SOPH	9.0 PPG	**STRETCH FORWARD**	
#4 Logan Lynch	**6'1**	**165 LBS**	65% FT	CONTEST OUTSIDE SHOTS - NO STRAIGHT LINE DRIVES	

This player is an undersized stretch forward who spaces the floor and operates primarily on the perimeter. In recent film, 41% of his field goal attempts have come from the three-point line, where he is currently shooting 29%. He is primarily a catch-and-shoot threat from the outside and is most effective when his feet are set. He does a good job using shot fakes to get defenders off balance and consistently plays off two feet, which keeps him under control and allows him to make solid decisions on closeouts. When he puts the ball on the floor, he prefers controlled, deliberate moves rather than explosive attacks. On the left block, if he begins his move middle, he will look to spin back over his right shoulder to finish. Because of his size, he relies more on skill and positioning than physicality. Defensively, we must keep him in front and avoid giving up straight-line drives. Closeouts need to be disciplined — contest from the outside without overcommitting to shot fakes. Force him left, limit clean catch-and-shoot opportunities, and make him finish over length and traffic inside.

RIGHTY		SENIOR	16.5 PPG	**POST - OFF GLASS**	
#41 Tony Katava	**6'7**	**195 LBS**	62% FT	KEEP OFF GLASS - WALL UP	

11% of his field goal attempts have come from three-point range, where he is shooting 24%. He is primarily a catch-and-shoot threat from outside and uses a jab step to create space before rising into his shot. We must be prepared to contest his perimeter attempts. On the block, he does an excellent job sealing to establish position. On the right block, he looks to attack baseline. On the left block, he will attack middle and also face up to drive. From the wings, he drops his shoulder to get downhill and prefers to finish going right. He is very active on the glass, averaging 9.1 rebounds per game, including 5 offensive rebounds per game. We must keep him off the glass, wall up in the paint, eliminate paint touches, and be ready to contest shots from the outside.

Thoughts for the game

PLAY ST. EDWARD HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL

GUYS TO FOUL IN LATE GAME SITUATION	GUYS TO AVOID FOULINIG
#1 - #3	#14 - #11

BENCH

RIGHTY — SOPH — 4.5 PPG — **BACKUP PG - HIGH VOL. 3PT**

#1 Nathan Sabin — 5'9 — 118 LBS — 77% FT — KEEP IN FRONT - BE PHYSICAL - CONTEST SHOTS

This guard is a perimeter-oriented scorer, with 67% of his field goal attempts coming from three-point range, and he is shooting 33% from 3PT. He is primarily a catch-and-shoot threat from the outside, but he is capable of using the dribble to create space when defenders close out too aggressively. He likes to utilize a pull-back dribble into a crossover to free himself up and is comfortable rising into shots off separation. He is a solid ball handler who can operate in space and is especially dangerous in the open floor. He is a very quick guard in transition, looking to push tempo and attack before the defense is set. When driving the basketball, he primarily looks to finish going to his right, and he has shown the ability to spin back to his right if cut off initially. Around the rim, he will use a floater to finish over length rather than absorbing contact. Defensively, we must locate him early in transition, keep him in front, and contest all outside shots. Discipline on closeouts is critical to take away his catch-and-shoot rhythm while preventing right-hand drives and spin-backs to his dominant side.

RIGHTY — FRESH — 4.9 PPG — **HIGH VOLUME 3PT**

#3 Mason Sauric — 6'0 — 155 LBS — 65% FT — CONTEST HIS SHOTS - ELIMINATE FACE CUTS

This player is an extreme perimeter-oriented scorer, with 75% of his field goal attempts coming from the three-point line, and he is converting at a highly efficient 40% from three. He is primarily a catch-and-shoot threat from the outside, spacing the floor and looking to capitalize on defensive lapses. However, he is not strictly stationary — if defenders close out recklessly, he will use one or two dribbles to create space for his jumper.

When he does put the ball on the floor, he is looking to drive right to finish at the rim. That said, he does not finish well through contact, and physicality can impact his effectiveness inside. He is much more comfortable attacking in rhythm than absorbing pressure at the rim.

Defensively, we must be disciplined and detailed. Eliminate face cuts, stay connected off the ball, and do not lose vision. On the catch, we need to force him left, run him off the line under control, and contest all outside shots. Take away his rhythm threes and make him score over length and physicality inside.

RIGHTY — SOPH — 4.1 PPG — **HIGH VOLUME 3PT**

#14 Luke Gerard — 6'1 — 160 LBS — 72% FT — CONTEST HIS SHOTS - FORCE LEFT

This player is an extreme perimeter-oriented shooter, with 76% of his field goal attempts coming from the three-point line, though he is currently shooting 21% from three. Despite the percentage, the volume demands discipline, as he is primarily a catch-and-shoot threat from the outside who looks to step into rhythm shots with his feet set. He moves very well without the basketball, consistently cutting to the rim when defenders lose vision or over-help. When he does put the ball on the floor, he is looking to finish going right at the rim, showing a clear strong-hand preference. In addition, he is active on the glass, averaging 3.9 rebounds per game, so we must finish possessions with physical box-outs. Defensively, we need to locate him early in transition, force him left, and contest all outside shots, taking away his catch-and-shoot rhythm while eliminating clean looks from three.

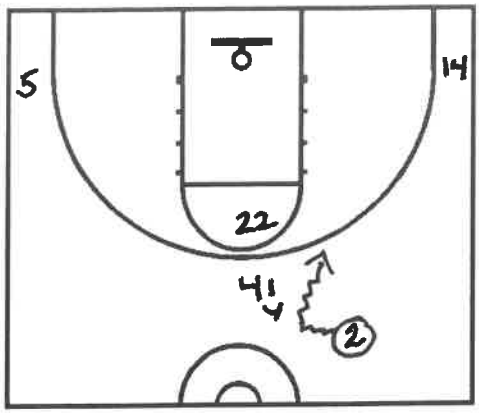
RIGHTY — SOPH — 7.0 PPG — **STRETCH FORWARD**

#11 Connor Witte — 6'4 — 195 LBS — 88% FT — WALL UP - ELIMINATE PAINT TOUCHES - KEEP OFF GLASS

This player has taken 30% of his field goal attempts from the three-point line and is currently shooting 22% from three, showing he is willing to space the floor but has not been highly efficient from the outside. He is capable in catch-and-shoot situations, so we must still contest and avoid giving him rhythm looks. In ball screen action, he rolls hard to the rim, putting pressure on the defense and looking to finish or score off drive-and-dump situations. On the right block, he consistently looks to attack baseline, and from the short corner he will also attack baseline using a strong drop shoulder to create space. When operating on the left block, he will look to face up and attack the rim. He is decisive once he makes his move and looks to play through contact inside. He is averaging 3.5 rebounds per game, so he will pursue second-chance opportunities if not checked. Defensively, we must wall up at the rim, eliminate paint touches, contest outside shots under control, and keep him off the glass. Physical box-outs and disciplined closeouts will be critical to limiting his overall impact.

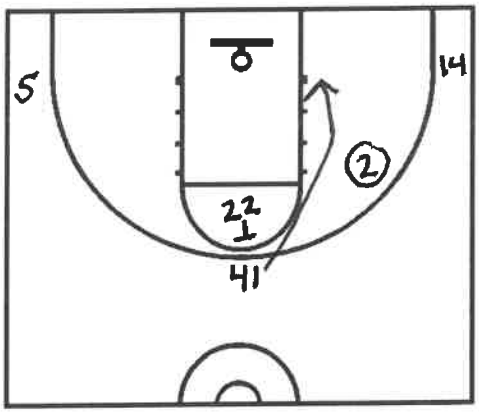
Saint Edward High School Basketball

Ball Screen To Back Screen

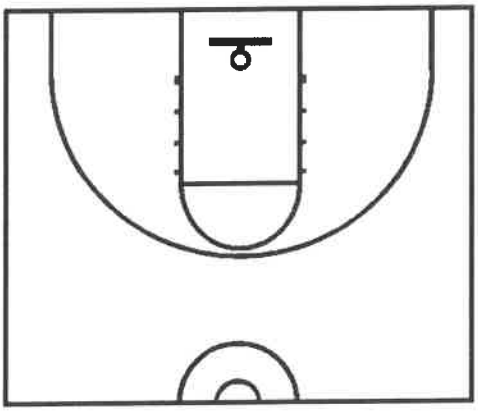


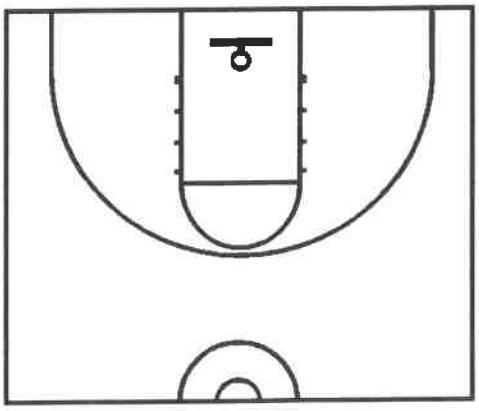
Ball Screen For 2

- Watch For Him To Reject Screen

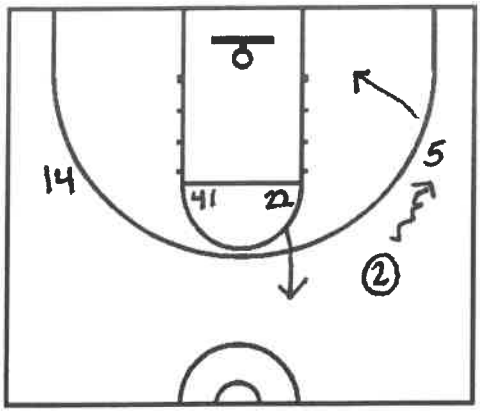


Back Screen For 41



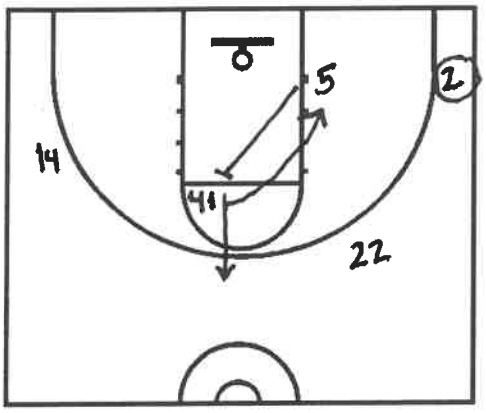


Saint Edward High School Basketball

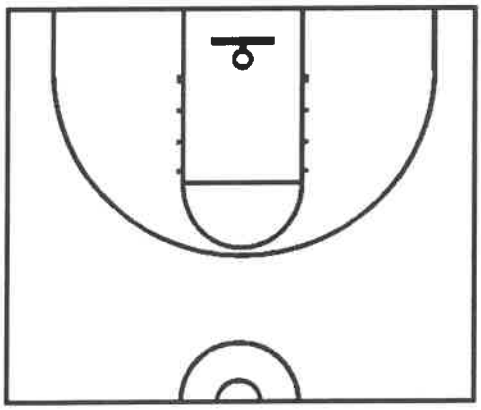


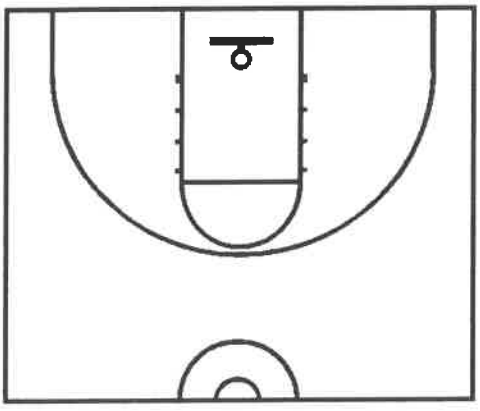
PG PUSHES WING THRU

BALL SIDE WING (22) POPS



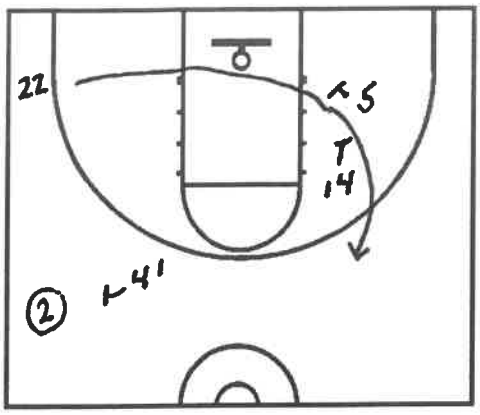
BACK SCREEN FOR POST





Saint Edward High School Basketball

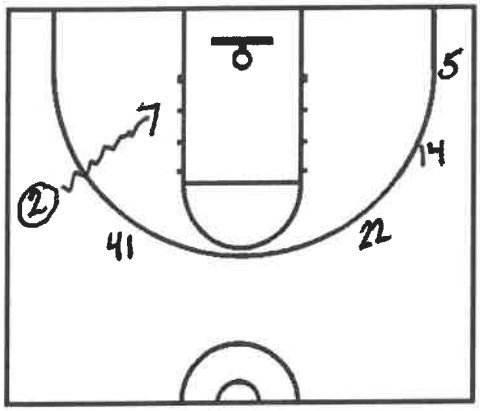
PULL SHIRT



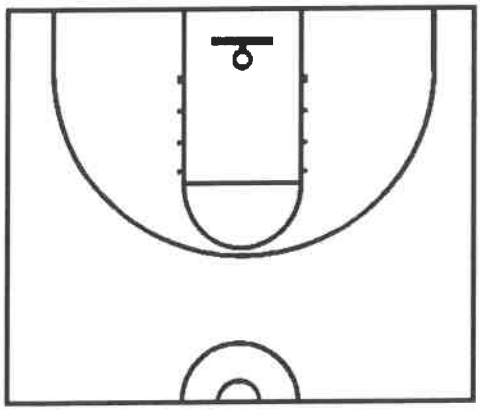
BALL SCREEN

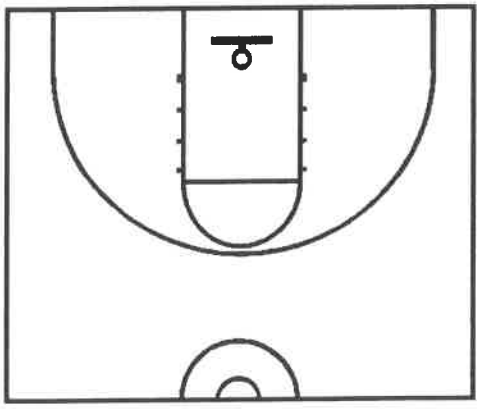
PUSH GUARD THRU

WEAKSIDE DOUBLE



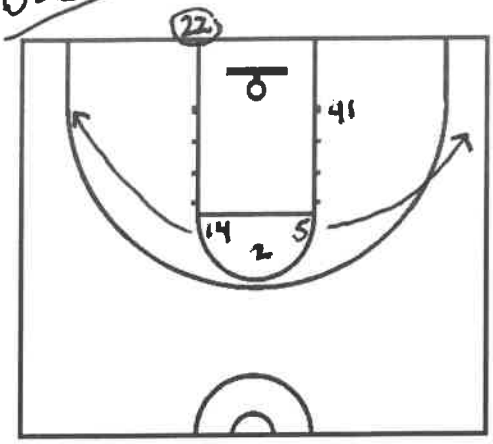
2 WILL LOOK FOR CLEAROUT



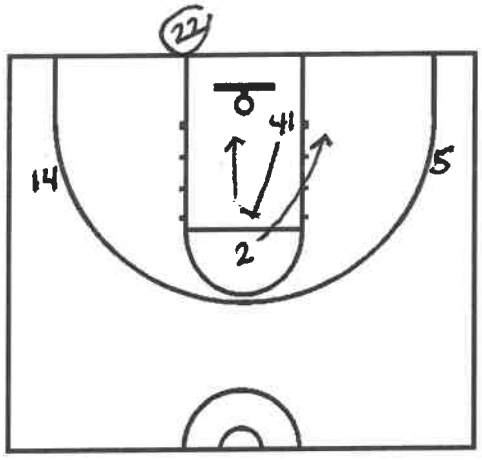


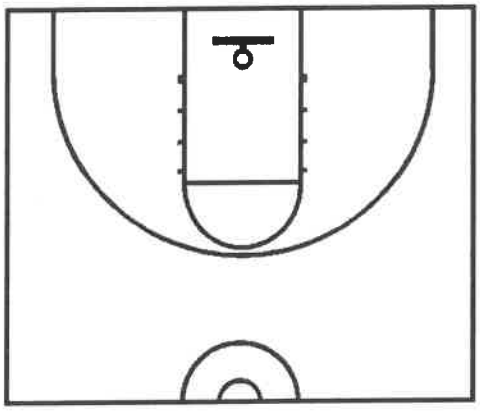
BLOB

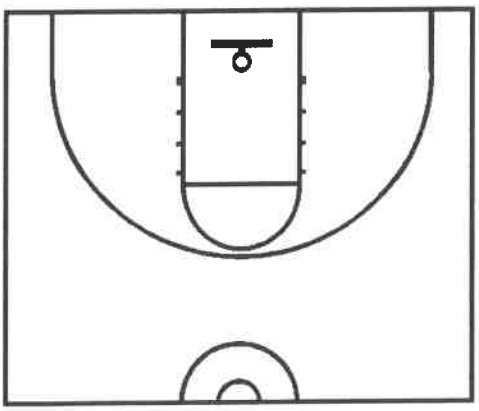
Saint Edward High School Basketball



FLAT ONE ACTION



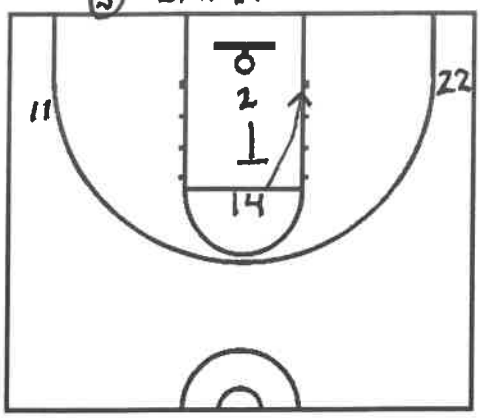




Saint Edward High School Basketball

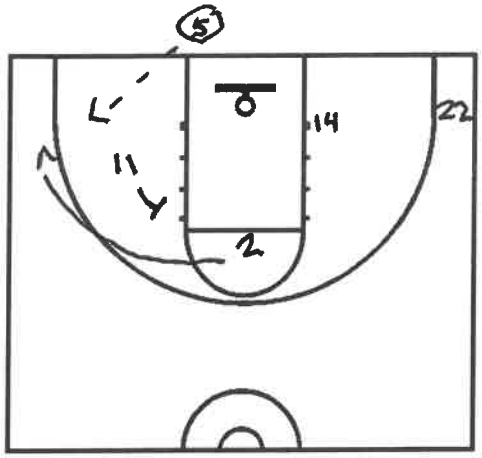
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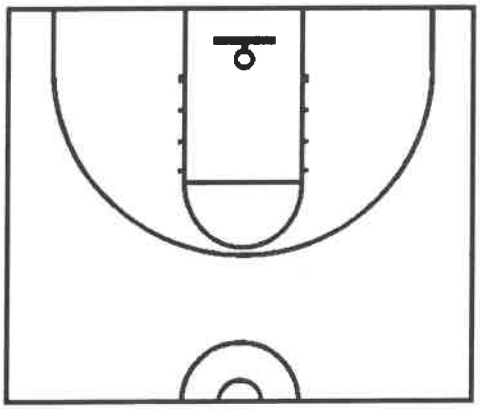
(5) "BAMA"

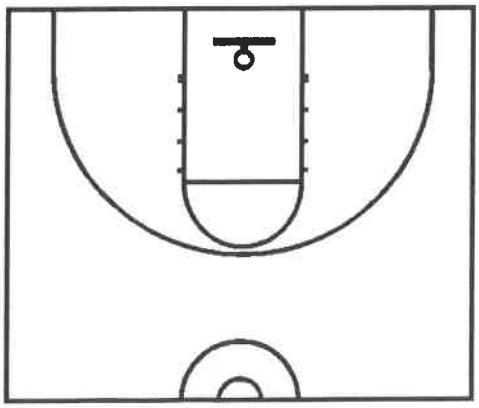


(5)

FLAT 2 ACTION

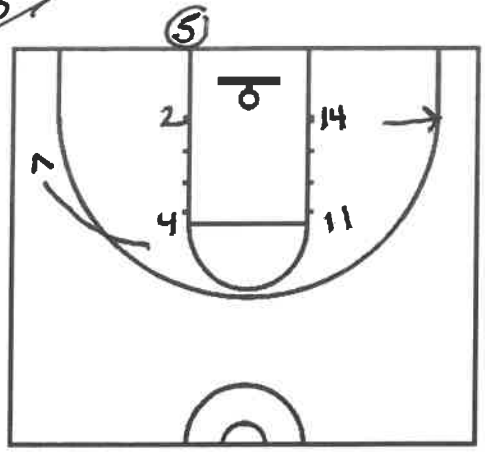






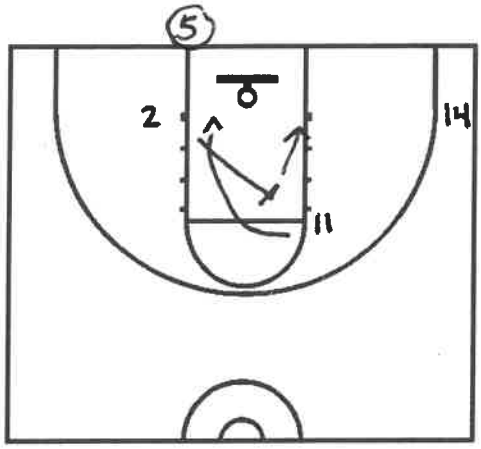
BLOB

Saint Edward High School Basketball

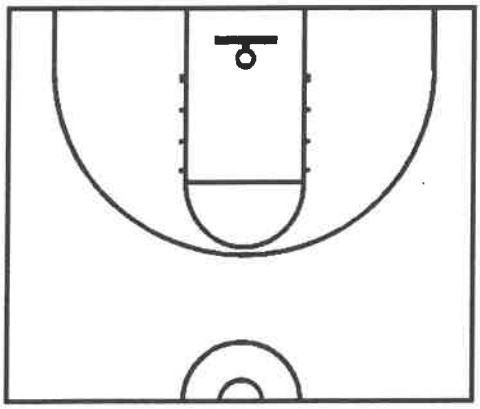


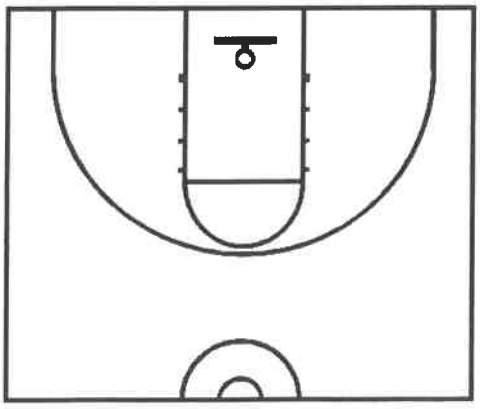
BOX ALLIGNMENT

4/14 POP TO CORNERS



2 SETS SCREEN FOR 11





MAXPREPS America's Source for High School Sports

Mentor Basketball Team Season Stats (2025-26)

Mascot Cardinals **Team** Varsity 2025-26 **Colors** Scarlet, Gray
Coach N/A **Address** 6477 Center St, Mentor, OH 44060
Overall 16-8 **Conference** 8-6 **State (OH) Rank** 69
League Greater Cleveland **Division** OH Division I



Game Stats

#	Athlete Name	GP	MPG	PPG	DEFR	OFFR	RPG	APG	SPG	BPG	TPG	PFPG
1	N. Sabin (So)	24		4.5	0.8	0.0	0.8	1.0	0.4	0.1	0.5	1.4
2	J. Kennedy (So)	24		17.3	3.3	2.8	6.1	8.3	3.6	0.4	2.7	1.5
3	M. Sauric (Fr)	24		4.9	1.0	0.3	1.3	0.9	1.0	0.0	1.1	1.8
4	L. Lynch (So)	20		9.0	2.2	0.9	3.1	0.6	0.9	0.1	1.2	1.7
5	T. Pavicic (So)	24		7.8	1.6	0.7	2.4	3.0	2.7	0.3	1.8	2.8
10	Z. Reilly (Jr)	8		0.8	0.3	0.3	0.5	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.8	0.1
11	C. Witte (So)	23		7.0	1.9	1.4	3.3	0.4	0.9	0.5	0.9	0.8
13	T. Johnson (Jr)	6		0.0	0.5	0.0	0.5	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.8	0.0
14	L. Gerard (So)	24		4.1	2.3	1.5	3.8	2.0	1.1	0.1	1.0	2.1
15	B. Lambert (So)	7		0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.3	0.1	0.0	0.6	0.3
20	G. Remner (So)	11	0.1	0.8	0.2	0.2	0.4	0.1	0.2	0.0	0.5	0.5
22	B. Gnjatic (Jr)	23		7.0	1.9	1.0	2.9	1.8	2.2	0.5	1.3	2.6
24	J. Lairson (Fr)	14	0.1	0.4	0.3	0.0	0.3	0.6	0.1	0.0	0.6	0.4
30	D. Gnjatic (Sr)	15	0.1	2.4	0.4	0.3	0.7	0.3	0.3	0.0	0.5	0.8
33	L. Crowley (Fr)	1		3.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	1.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
41	T. Katava (Sr)	24		16.5	3.9	4.8	8.8	0.8	1.0	1.0	1.9	1.3
45	J. Helcberger (Fr)	2		1.0	1.5	0.5	2.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	1.5
	Season Totals	24		78.6	19.1	13.6	32.8	19.1	13.9	3.0	13.6	16.5

Shooting

#	Athlete Name	GP	Min	Pts	FGM	FGA	FG%	PPS	AFG%
1	N. Sabin (So)	24		108	39	91	43	1.2	54
2	J. Kennedy (So)	24		415	146	359	41	1.2	45
3	M. Sauric (Fr)	24		117	39	102	38	1.1	52
4	L. Lynch (So)	20		179	66	156	42	1.1	48
5	T. Pavicic (So)	24		188	64	152	42	1.2	54
10	Z. Reilly (Jr)	8		6	3	7	43	0.9	43
11	C. Witte (So)	23		161	70	112	63	1.4	66
13	T. Johnson (Jr)	6		0	0	1	0	0.0	0
	Season Totals	24	4	1887	692	1585	44	1.2	51

#	Athlete Name	GP	Min	Pts	FGM	FGA	FG%	PPS	AFG%
14	L. Gerard (So)	24		98	33	110	30	0.9	39
15	B. Lambert (So)	7		0	0	0			
20	G. Remner (So)	11	1	9	4	8	50	1.1	56
22	B. Gnjatic (Jr)	23		162	57	130	44	1.2	60
24	J. Lairson (Fr)	14	1	6	3	15	20	0.4	20
30	D. Gnjatic (Sr)	15	2	36	13	38	34	0.9	46
33	L. Crowley (Fr)	1		3	1	1	100	3.0	150
41	T. Katava (Sr)	24		397	153	300	51	1.3	53
45	J. Helcberger (Fr)	2		2	1	3	33	0.7	33
	Season Totals	24	4	1887	692	1585	44	1.2	51

#	Athlete Name	GP	Min	Pts	3PM	3PA	3P%	FTM	FTA	FT%	2FGM	2FGA	2FG%
1	N. Sabin (So)	24		108	20	62	32	10	13	77	19	29	66
2	J. Kennedy (So)	24		415	28	96	29	95	110	86	118	263	45
3	M. Sauric (Fr)	24		117	28	75	37	11	17	65	11	27	41
4	L. Lynch (So)	20		179	19	66	29	28	43	65	47	90	52
5	T. Pavicic (So)	24		188	35	106	33	25	37	68	29	46	63
10	Z. Reilly (Jr)	8		6	0	3	0	0	0	0	3	4	75
11	C. Witte (So)	23		161	7	32	22	14	16	88	63	80	79
13	T. Johnson (Jr)	6		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
14	L. Gerard (So)	24		98	19	84	23	13	18	72	14	26	54
15	B. Lambert (So)	7		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
20	G. Remner (So)	11	1	9	1	3	33	0	0	0	3	5	60
22	B. Gnjatic (Jr)	23		162	41	106	39	7	14	50	16	24	67
24	J. Lairson (Fr)	14	1	6	0	8	0	0	2	0	3	7	43
30	D. Gnjatic (Sr)	15	2	36	9	31	29	1	2	50	4	7	57
33	L. Crowley (Fr)	1		3	1	1	100	0	0	0	0	0	0
41	T. Katava (Sr)	24		397	9	35	26	82	132	62	144	265	54
45	J. Helcberger (Fr)	2		2	0	1	0	0	0	0	1	2	50
	Season Totals	24	4	1887	217	709	31	286	404	71	475	876	54

Totals

#	Athlete Name	GP	Min	Pts	OReb	DReb	Reb	Ast	Stl	Blk	TO	PF
1	N. Sabin (So)	24		108	0	18	18	24	10	3	13	33
2	J. Kennedy (So)	24		415	68	78	146	199	86	9	64	35
3	M. Sauric (Fr)	24		117	7	25	32	21	23	1	26	42
4	L. Lynch (So)	20		179	18	43	61	12	18	1	24	34
5	T. Pavicic (So)	24		188	16	38	57	71	65	7	43	66
10	Z. Reilly (Jr)	8		6	2	2	4	0	0	0	6	1
	Season Totals	24	4	1887	326	459	788	459	333	71	327	397

#	Athlete Name	GP	Min	Pts	OReb	DReb	Reb	Ast	Stl	Blk	TO	PF
11	C. Witte (So)	23		161	33	44	77	10	21	11	21	18
13	T. Johnson (Jr)	6		0	0	3	3	0	0	0	5	0
14	L. Gerard (So)	24		98	35	55	90	48	26	3	24	51
15	B. Lambert (So)	7		0	0	0	0	2	1	0	4	2
20	G. Remner (So)	11	1	9	2	2	4	1	2	0	6	6
22	B. Gnjatic (Jr)	23		162	23	44	67	41	50	11	29	59
24	J. Lairson (Fr)	14	1	6	0	4	4	8	1	0	8	5
30	D. Gnjatic (Sr)	15	2	36	5	6	11	4	5	0	8	12
33	L. Crowley (Fr)	1		3	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	0
41	T. Katava (Sr)	24		397	116	94	210	18	24	25	46	30
45	J. Helcberger (Fr)	2		2	1	3	4	0	0	0	0	3
	Season Totals	24	4	1887	326	459	788	459	333	71	327	397

Misc Totals

#	Athlete Name	GP	Ast:TO	Stl:TO	Stl:PF	Blk:PF	Chr	Defl	TF	DD	TD
1	N. Sabin (So)	24	1.85	0.77	0.30	0.09	4	19			
2	J. Kennedy (So)	24	3.11	1.34	2.46	0.26	2	82		4	
3	M. Sauric (Fr)	24	0.81	0.89	0.55	0.02	8	20			
4	L. Lynch (So)	20	0.50	0.75	0.53	0.03	1	17			
5	T. Pavicic (So)	24	1.65	1.51	0.99	0.11	16	47			
10	Z. Reilly (Jr)	8	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0	1			
11	C. Witte (So)	23	0.48	1.00	1.17	0.61	1	34			
13	T. Johnson (Jr)	6	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0	1			
14	L. Gerard (So)	24	2.00	1.08	0.51	0.06	1	39			
15	B. Lambert (So)	7	0.50	0.25	0.50	0.00	0	0			
20	G. Remner (So)	11	0.17	0.33	0.33	0.00	0	4	0		
22	B. Gnjatic (Jr)	23	1.41	1.72	0.85	0.19	1	84		1	
24	J. Lairson (Fr)	14	1.00	0.13	0.20	0.00	0	0			
30	D. Gnjatic (Sr)	15	0.50	0.63	0.42	0.00	0	5	0		
33	L. Crowley (Fr)	1	0.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	0	3			
41	T. Katava (Sr)	24	0.39	0.52	0.80	0.83	1	28		10	
45	J. Helcberger (Fr)	2	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0	1			
	Season Totals	24	1.40	1.02	0.84	0.18	35	385	0	15	

Per 32

#	Athlete Name	Min	Pts/32	Ast/32	Reb/32	Stl/32	Blk/32	TO/32	PF/32
20	G. Remner (So)	1							
24	J. Lairson (Fr)	1							
	Season Totals	4							

#	Athlete Name	Min	Pts/32	Ast/32	Reb/32	Stl/32	Blk/32	TO/32	PF/32
30	D. Gnjatic (Sr)	2							
	Season Totals	4							